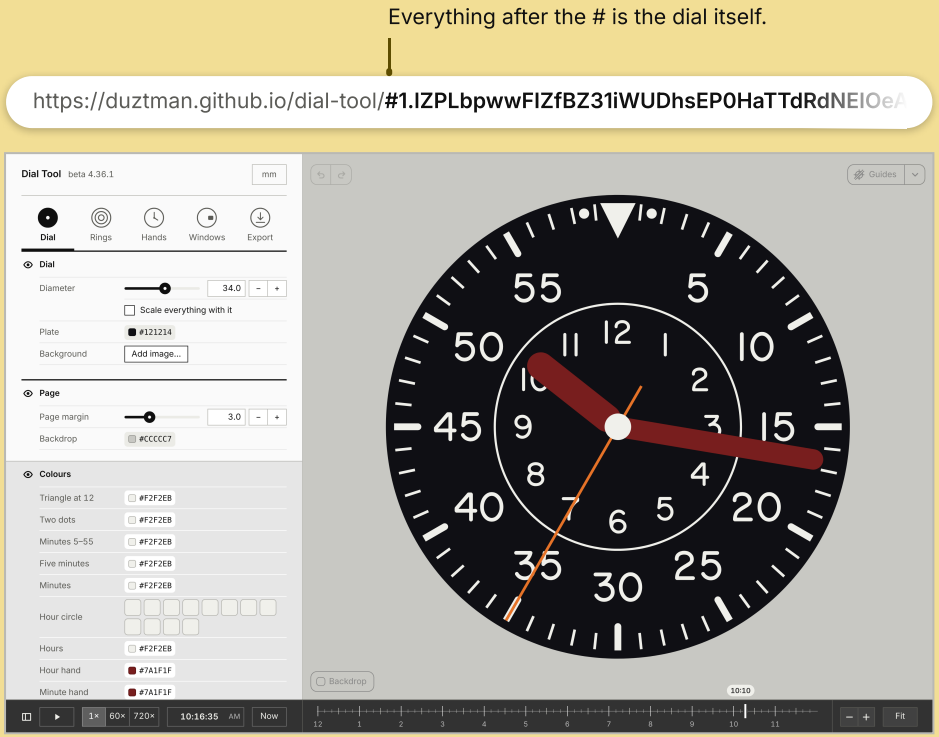
Start

Open the address and start drawing.
Nothing to install, nothing to sign up for.





Top right of the panel: closed, then open



The same dial's link, in the Export tab

Where it runs. The tool is one web page, duztman.github.io/dial-tool. It is tested in Chrome on a Mac and on an iPad, where it works by finger. Chrome and Edge can also use your computer's own fonts, once you allow it.

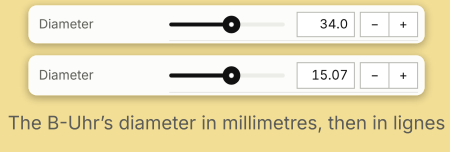
Opening a dial. A link someone sends you opens their dial, ready to change, and nothing of yours is lost: the bare address, with nothing after it, brings back the last dial you worked on here.

Sizes and units. Every length is the real length on the finished dial. The unit box, top right of the panel, sets the unit you read and type in: millimetres, points, inches, or lignes, the watchmakers' unit for movement sizes.

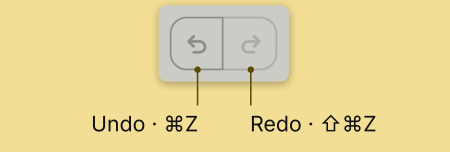
⚠ **Watch.** The unit box changes only what you read and type. The dial, its link and its files stay in millimetres.

Saving and sharing. Everything after the # is the dial itself, rewritten with every change. Bookmark the address to keep a dial, or send it to share one; Copy link, in the Export tab, copies it for you.

⚠ **Watch.** A link carries the dial, not its fonts. A font from your own computer reaches the other person only if they have it too; otherwise they see a stand-in.



The B-Uhr's diameter in millimetres, then in lignes

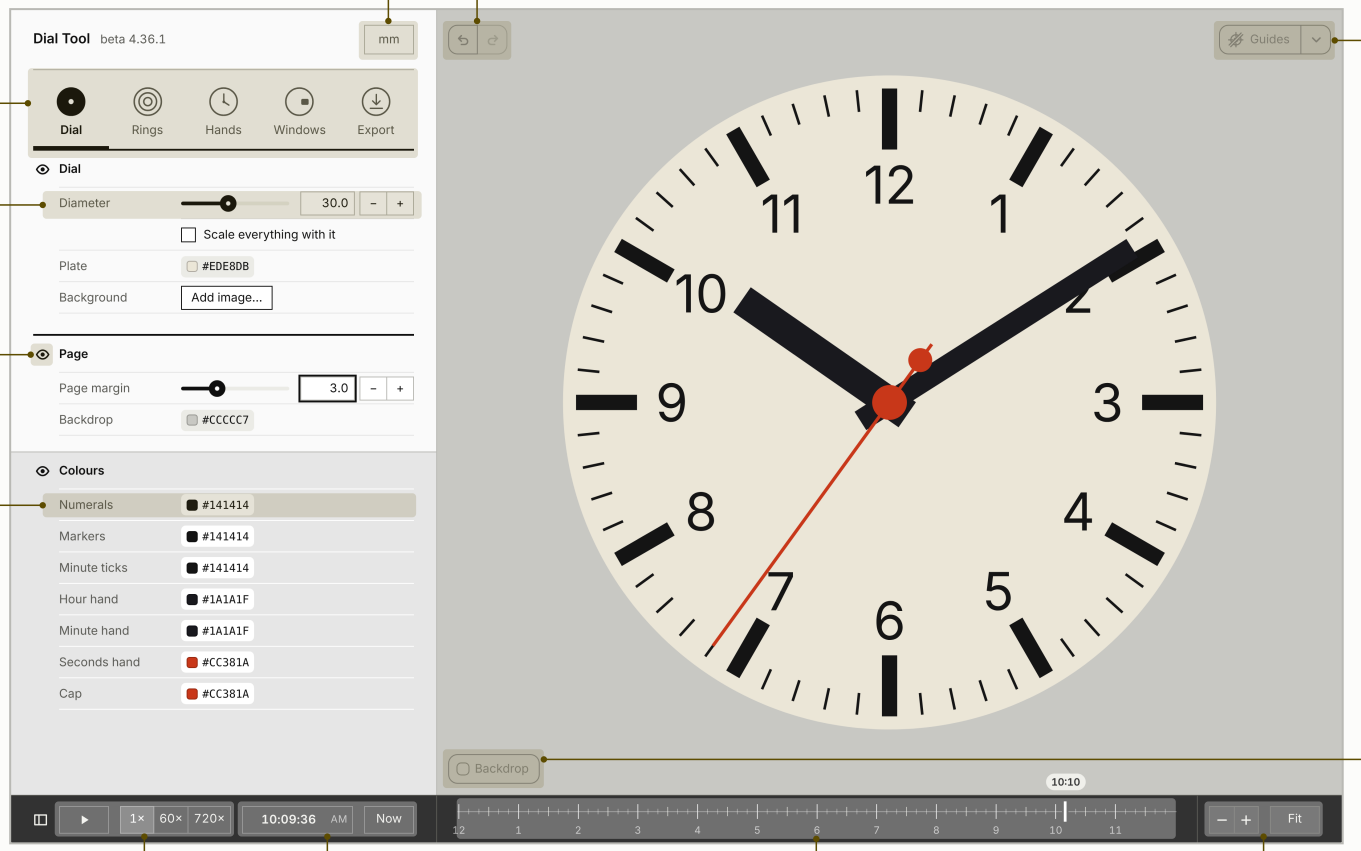


Lignes. Movements are sold by width in lignes: one ligne is 2.2558 mm, so an 11½‴ movement is 25.94 mm wide. In lignes, a dial is sized against one.

Undo and redo. Each pause after a change is a step you can go back to. On a PC the keys are Ctrl Z and Ctrl Shift Z, or Ctrl Y instead.

The whole window

Settings on the left, the dial on the right, the time along the bottom.
Five tabs choose what the panel edits; the dial redraws as you change it.



Typing numbers. A number field also does sums: +0.5 adds, x2 doubles, /3 takes a third. Useful when a drawing says “a third of the radius”.

On an iPad. Everything works by finger. Small controls answer to a press a little outside their edge, and knobs and swatches are drawn larger.

⚠ **Watch.** Guides and the backdrop are for the screen only. Nothing you see in them reaches an exported file.

Rings

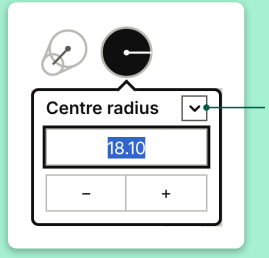
Every mark, number and track on a dial is a ring.
A ring repeats one kind of thing round the centre.



What a ring is. One row in the list, drawn at one radius. Tracks, hour marks, numbers, bezels and zones of colour are all rings; this diver has eleven.

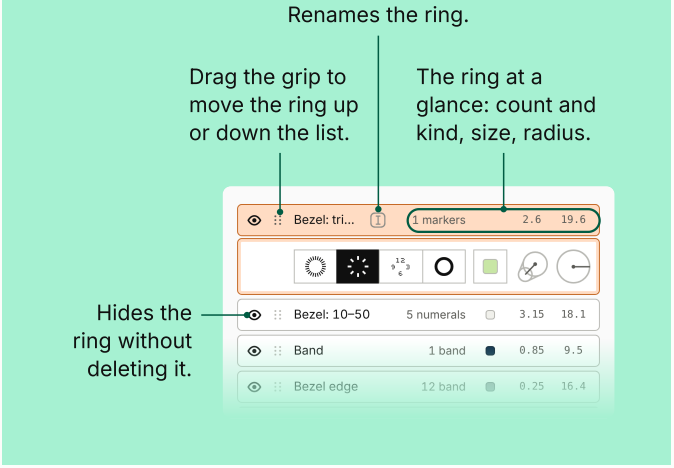
⚠ **Watch.** A ring's radius runs from the centre to the outer edge of ticks, markers and bands, and to a numeral's anchor: its middle, its baseline or its top.

Four kinds. Ticks are lines, as on a minute track. Markers are heavier shapes, usually for the hours. Numerals are numbers or words. A band is flat colour, whole or in pieces. A ring can change to another kind at any time, and it keeps all of its settings when it does.



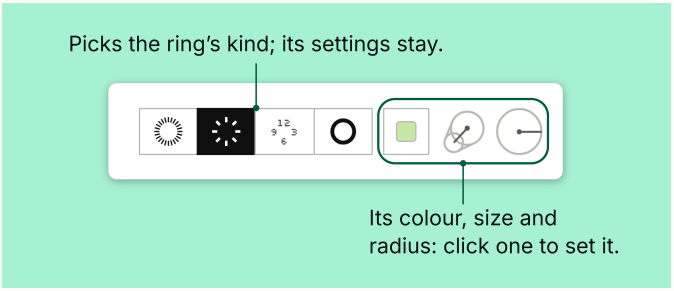
Sets a numeral's anchor: centre, baseline or top.

Adding and arranging. A new ring or a copy goes in above the selected ring and becomes the selected one. A new numerals ring takes its type from the numerals already on the dial. Duplicate is the quick way to a second track: copy one, then change its radius.



Stacking order. The list is the stacking order: the top ring is drawn last, over the ones below it. Hide a ring to see what it covers.

⚠ **Watch.** A ring gives way only to rings above it, so moving it can bring marks back or take them away. Hidden, a ring is neither drawn nor exported, and no ring gives way to it.



The ring drawer. It opens under the selected ring's row. Click a value button to type a number, or press it and drag: right or up raises the value, and Shift makes each step finer.

